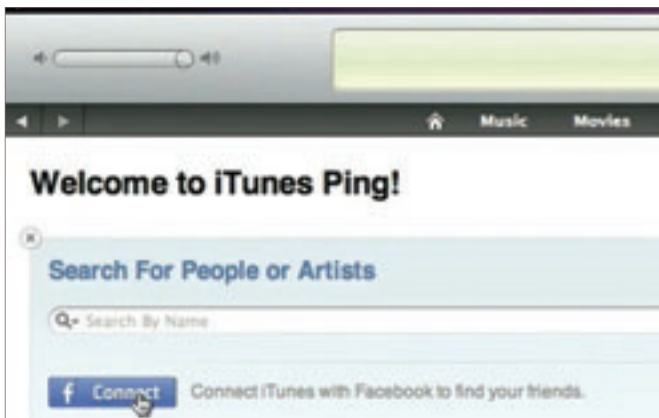


Cloud OS

Jolicloud 1.0, a free HTML5-based web-centric Linux OS, releases to public

Age of Empires for Windows

Robot Entertainment announces Age of Empires MMO game for Windows



Apple releases iTunes 10 Ping!

Apple just launched iTunes 10 and will offer its users many new features, including Apple TV playback synchronization (playback across iOS devices using the cloud). The biggest new feature in iTunes 10 would have to be Ping, a new social network. The new social networking service, oriented

around music will let people follow artists and get updates as they post their opinions, pictures and release music. iTunes 10 will also feature HDTV show rentals which form a big part of the new Apple TV. Rented television show episodes will be available up to 30 days after purchase, and will expire 48 hours after you start watching it.

"Wave in a Box" at a server near you

Google Wave has been sentenced to death and that must have hurt Google, abandoning a product which they launched with so much pomp and promise. So now Google has taken a step which is sure to delight developers and ensure that Google Wave lives on, even if it isn't on Google's own servers. Dubbed as 'Wave in a Box', the new venture will expand on the existing 2,00,000 lines of open-source code from the Wave project and it will let developers continue developing it. Google will be opening up a significant portion of their previously closed parts of Wave, including a lot of the server and client code that forms the front-end of the project. Those running Wave in the Box will be able to

run it on their own server, and have real-time communication. Google Wave in a Box users will also be able to configure their "boxes" to federate across instances! So you could use your Wave setup to communicate with other Wave setups, just like email.

Enterprises could always implement their own Wave servers based on the open source clients, servers and protocols Google had developed. Novell

Pulse, for example is a Google Wave-based solution. Despite Google Wave's closure, Novell will continue developing Pulse as intended. Google will also provide a means to import the current Google Wave conversations to the users own server, so they will be able to find a new place for the data once Google Wave shuts down at the end of this year.



Mozilla furthers Open Web Gaming

A new initiative by Mozilla Labs has been unveiled which aims to make the web a better environment for gaming. Whether it is by using Flash Player or other plugins and add-ons in the browser — as in the case of Quake Live — gaming is something that had until recently been out of the purview of web browsers, requiring additional assistance of in some form.

Recent additions to web standards have made it quite possible to have a platform agnostic game now, which will run on any platform as long

as it is standards compliant. The new Canvas element can be used for advanced applications from image editing and video processing application and even a full-fledged NES emulator called JsNES which downloads NES roms and plays the game straight from the browser.

The future lies in hardware accelerated web browsers. Browsers in the time to come will render content using the graphics hardware of the system, meaning richer, faster, smoother animated content on the web. This also translated favorably for games which

can perhaps make best use of hardware acceleration. Mozilla has started shipping Firefox with hardware acceleration turned on since Beta 5 of the browser, and Internet Explorer 9 has also showcased hardware acceleration. If you're having doubts about how much this can affect rendering performance of a browser, consider this, Chrome which is the fastest browser in terms of Javascript performance, gains a score which is in the mere 60s to 80s in IE9's Psychedelic Browser test, while both Firefox 4 and IE9 have scores upwards of 1500!

WebGL is another browser standard technology which will revolutionize 3D content, such as games, on the web. With WebGL browsers will be able to render full-fledged interactive 3D content in the browser as a part of the web page itself. Since WebGL is based on OpenGL ES, which is used on mobile devices, even portable devices can support the standard.

To kick off this venture they have announced the "Game On 2010 Competition" open to all developers. The future is bright for browser-based gaming, and it seems Mozilla has taken a hold of its reins.